

WH Questions — Mixed Tenses & Contractions

Part 1 builds WH questions across mixed tenses. **Part 2** zooms into 's and 'd — the two contractions that hide an auxiliary.

A Parte 1 constrói perguntas WH em tempos verbais variados. A Parte 2 foca em 's e 'd — as duas contrações que escondem um auxiliar.

Nome / Name: _____

Data / Date: _____

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WH Questions · Mixed Tenses

Every sentence is an answer. Build the question. · Cada frase é uma resposta. Construa a pergunta.

1 The two families · As duas famílias

No matter the tense — present, past, past perfect, future — every question either **creates an auxiliary from scratch** or **takes one that already exists and moves it**. Decide this first.

FAMÍLIA 1

Adds the auxiliary

The original sentence has **no auxiliary** — just the main verb, present or past simple. The question creates one from scratch: **Do / Does** in the present, **Did** in the past. The main verb goes back to its base form.

She works from home. → Where **does** she work from?

They arrived last night. → When **did** they arrive?

FAMÍLIA 2

Inverts the existing auxiliary

The original sentence **already has** an auxiliary — is, are, was, were, has, have, had, will, would, can, could, should, might. The question just **inverts the order**: the auxiliary jumps before the subject.

She is working from home. → Where **is** she working from?

They had already arrived. → When **had** they already arrived?

WATCH OUT FOR 'S AND 'D · CUIDADO COM 'S E 'D

's can mean **is** (with an adjective or -ing verb: "she's tired", "she's working") or **has** (with a past participle: "she's finished"). 'd can mean **had** (with a participle: "she'd finished") or **would** (with a base verb: "she'd love that"). See Part 2 to drill this in depth.

2 Solved example · Exemplo resolvido

MODEL · MODELO

He's finally finished the marathon after months of training.

Ele finalmente terminou a maratona depois de meses de treino.

Think / Pense: "finished" is a past participle, so 's = has (present perfect) — "he has finished." "The marathon" is a thing, so the question starts with What. Family 2: the auxiliary already exists, just invert it.

→ **What has he finally finished after months of training?**

3 Your turn · 15 sentences · Sua vez · 15 frases

Before you start · Antes de começar

— Write the **complete sentence** — subject, auxiliary, and verb, not just the WH word.

Escreva a frase completa — sujeito, auxiliar e verbo, não só a WH word.

— Start with a **capital letter** and end with a **question mark (?)**.

Comece com letra maiúscula e termine com ponto de interrogação (?)

— The highlighted part is the **answer** — don't copy it into your question.

A parte destacada é a resposta — não a copie dentro da sua pergunta.

01

Mia is designing **a new logo** for a client right now.

Mia está desenhando um novo logo para um cliente agora.

Família 2 · Presente contínuo

Q:

02

Sophie found her passport **under the couch**.

Sophie achou o passaporte dela embaixo do sofá.

Família 1 · Passado simples

Q:

03

Sophie has been learning Spanish **for two years**.

Sophie está aprendendo espanhol há dois anos.

Família 2 · Presente perfeito contínuo

Q:

04

Tom calls **his mentor** every Friday afternoon.

Tom liga para o mentor dele toda sexta à tarde.

Família 1 · Presente simples

Q:

05

Lena had already left the office **because she felt sick**.

Lena já tinha saído do escritório porque estava se sentindo mal.

Família 2 · Passado perfeito

Q:

06

Mia can speak **three languages** fluently.

Mia consegue falar três idiomas fluentemente.

Família 2 · Modal (can)

Q:

07

She'd already finished **her homework** before dinner.

Ela já tinha terminado o dever de casa antes do jantar.

Família 2 · Passado perfeito (contração)

Q:

08

Jake has visited Portugal **three times**.

Jake visitou Portugal três vezes.

Família 2 · Presente perfeito

Q:

09

Tom and Mia go to the gym **twice a week**.

Tom e Mia vão à academia duas vezes por semana.

Família 1 · Presente simples

Q:

10

Daniel was repairing **his bike** when the rain started.

Daniel estava consertando a bicicleta dele quando a chuva começou.

Família 2 · Passado contínuo

Q:

11

Sophie has to work overtime **because of the deadline**.

Sophie precisa trabalhar horas extras por causa do prazo.

Família 1 · Presente simples (have to)

Q:

12

Daniel apologized to **his neighbor** after the noise complaint.

Daniel se desculpou com o vizinho dele depois da reclamação de barulho.

Família 1 · Passado simples

Q:

13

Jake will finish the report **by Thursday**.

Jake vai terminar o relatório até quinta-feira.

Família 2 · Futuro (will)

Q:

14

He's really nervous **about the exam** tomorrow.

Ele está realmente nervoso com a prova amanhã.

Família 2 · Presente simples (contração)

Q:

15

Tom is going to move to **a new apartment** next month.

Tom vai se mudar para um apartamento novo mês que vem.

Família 2 · Futuro (going to)

Q:

2

's and 'd — which one is it?

Decode the contraction, then build the question. · Decifre a contração, depois construa a pergunta.

1 The four patterns · Os quatro padrões

Look at the word right after the contraction — it decides everything. Olhe a palavra logo depois da contração — ela decide tudo.

'S = IS

Followed by an **adjective** or a verb in **-ing**.
Describes a state or something happening now.

She's tired. · **She's working.**

'S = HAS

Followed by a **past participle** (usually -ed, or irregular: gone, done, seen). Reports something completed.

She's finished. · **She's gone.**

'D = WOULD

Followed by a **base verb** (no -ed, no -ing). Usually a wish, preference, or hypothesis.

She'd love that. · **She'd rather stay.**

'D = HAD

Followed by a **past participle**. Describes something that happened before another past moment.

She'd finished before I arrived.

2 Solved examples · Exemplos resolvidos

'S EXAMPLE

Mia's finished her portfolio for the interview.

Mia terminou o portfólio dela para a entrevista.

Think / Pense: "finished" is a past participle right after 's, so 's = has (present perfect) — "Mia has finished." The auxiliary already exists, just invert it.

→ **What has Mia finished for the interview?**

'D EXAMPLE

He'd love to see the northern lights someday.

Ele adoraria ver a aurora boreal algum dia.

Think / Pense: "love" is a base verb right after 'd, so 'd = would — "he would love." The auxiliary already exists, just invert it.

→ **What would he love to see someday?**

3 Your turn · 16 sentences · Sua vez · 16 frases

Before you start · Antes de começar

— Look at the word **right after** 's or 'd — that decides everything.

Olhe a palavra logo depois de 's ou 'd — isso decide tudo.

— Circle what the contraction means, **then** write the full question.

Circule o que a contração significa, depois escreva a pergunta completa.

— Start with a **capital letter** and end with a **question mark (?)**.

Comece com letra maiúscula e termine com ponto de interrogação (?)

01

Mia's really excited about **the concert this weekend**.

Mia está realmente animada com o show neste fim de semana.

's here means: (circle one)

☐ IS

☐ HAS

Q:

02

She'd love to travel around **Southeast Asia** someday.

Ela adoraria viajar pelo sudeste asiático algum dia.

'd here means: (circle one)

☐ WOULD

☐ HAD

Q:

03

Lena's finished **the report** ahead of schedule.

Lena terminou o relatório antes do prazo.

's here means: (circle one)

☐ IS

☐ HAS

Q:

04

He'd already booked the tickets **before the price went up**.

Ele já tinha reservado as passagens antes do preço subir.

'd here means: (circle one)

☐ WOULD

☐ HAD

Q:

05

Tom's working **from the new office downtown**.

Tom está trabalhando no novo escritório no centro.

's here means: (circle one)

☐ IS

☐ HAS

Q:

06

He'd rather **work from home** on Fridays.

Ele preferiria trabalhar de casa nas sextas.

'd here means: (circle one)

☐ WOULD

☐ HAD

Q:

07

Daniel's forgotten **his umbrella** again.*Daniel esqueceu o guarda-chuva dele de novo.*

's here means: (circle one)

☐ IS☐ HAS

Q: _____

08

She'd never tried **sushi** before that trip.*Ela nunca tinha experimentado sushi antes daquela viagem.*

'd here means: (circle one)

☐ WOULD☐ HAD

Q: _____

09

Sophie's busy with **the final exams this month**.*Sophie está ocupada com as provas finais este mês.*

's here means: (circle one)

☐ IS☐ HAS

Q: _____

10

They'd prefer **a quiet table near the window**.*Eles prefeririam uma mesa tranquila perto da janela.*

'd here means: (circle one)

☐ WOULD☐ HAD

Q: _____

11

Mia's moved to **a bigger apartment downtown**.*Mia se mudou para um apartamento maior no centro.*

's here means: (circle one)

☐ IS☐ HAS

Q: _____

12

They'd finished the meeting **before lunch**.*Eles tinham terminado a reunião antes do almoço.*

'd here means: (circle one)

☐ WOULD☐ HAD

Q: _____

13

Jake's driving **to the airport** right now.*Jake está dirigindo para o aeroporto agora.*

's here means: (circle one)

☐ IS☐ HAS

Q: _____

14

She'd definitely recommend **that course** to a beginner.

Ela recomendaria com certeza aquele curso para um iniciante.

'd here means: (circle one)

☐ WOULD

☐ HAD

Q:

15

Tom's already spoken to **the manager** about it.

Tom já falou com o gerente sobre isso.

's here means: (circle one)

☐ IS

☐ HAS

Q:

16

He'd left his phone **at the restaurant** by accident.

Ele tinha deixado o celular no restaurante sem querer.

'd here means: (circle one)

☐ WOULD

☐ HAD

Q:

Answer Key · Gabarito do Professor

Part 1 · WH Questions — Mixed Tenses

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. What is Mia designing for a client right now?2. Where did Sophie find her passport?3. How long has Sophie been learning Spanish?4. Who does Tom call every Friday afternoon?5. Why had Lena already left the office?6. How many languages can Mia speak fluently?7. What had she already finished before dinner?8. How many times has Jake visited Portugal? | <ol style="list-style-type: none">9. How often do Tom and Mia go to the gym?10. What was Daniel repairing when the rain started?11. Why does Sophie have to work overtime?12. Who did Daniel apologize to after the noise complaint?13. When will Jake finish the report?14. What is he nervous about tomorrow?15. Where is Tom going to move next month? |
|--|---|

Family 1 (blue tag) — Do / Does / Did, no auxiliary in the original sentence. **Family 2** (orange tag) — the auxiliary already existed and was inverted. Items 7 and 14 use the 's / 'd contraction trap (has vs. is, had vs. would).

Answer Key · Gabarito do Professor

Part 2 · 's and 'd — which one is it?

1. What is Mia excited about this weekend?

'S = IS · Presente simples

2. Where would she love to travel someday?

'D = WOULD · Modal hipotético

3. What has Lena finished ahead of schedule?

'S = HAS · Presente perfeito

4. When had he already booked the tickets?

'D = HAD · Passado perfeito

5. Where is Tom working from?

'S = IS · Presente contínuo

6. What would he rather do on Fridays?

'D = WOULD · Modal hipotético

7. What has Daniel forgotten again?

'S = HAS · Presente perfeito

8. What had she never tried before that trip?

'D = HAD · Passado perfeito

9. What is Sophie busy with this month?

'S = IS · Presente simples

10. What would they prefer?

'D = WOULD · Modal hipotético

11. Where has Mia moved?

'S = HAS · Presente perfeito

12. When had they finished the meeting?

'D = HAD · Passado perfeito

13. Where is Jake driving right now?

'S = IS · Presente contínuo

14. What would she recommend to a beginner?

'D = WOULD · Modal hipotético

15. Who has Tom already spoken to about it?

'S = HAS · Presente perfeito

16. Where had he left his phone by accident?

'D = HAD · Passado perfeito

Each item pairs a contraction with the word right after it — that word alone decides is/has or would/had. If a student circles the wrong option, check whether they read the word right after the contraction or guessed from the general meaning of the sentence.